

Wine: A Great Tool for Running Windows Programs on Linux

On switching over to Linux, many Windows users feel lost because they miss their favourite Windows programs. Wine provides a means of running those every programs on a Linux system. Here's a tutorial on installing MS Office on Linux using Wine.



One of the main concerns of people who are switching to Linux is how to run the programs in it that they are so used to running in other operating systems, especially Windows. Thankfully, Wine can help in solving this problem. The software that Windows users usually miss the most on Linux is Microsoft Office.

All .exe files can be run on Linux using Wine. Wine is software for UNIX-like systems, including Linux, OSX and the BSDs. It allows you to run native Windows applications. Wine stands for 'Wine Is Not an Emulator'. That's because it isn't. Wine isn't a full Windows install or some kind of VM. It is a compatibility layer that essentially translates Windows binaries. This extends to graphics libraries like DirectX 9, which are converted to OpenGL. Wine allows Linux users to run many popular Windows applications and games as if they were running on Windows itself, with a similar performance.

Wine can be tricky though. There are multiple versions of it with different sets of patches and two different current versions. Even when you get past that, different programs require specialised settings, in many cases, and can't just be run out-of-the-box. However, once you know

your way around and have configured a program to run properly through Wine, it will usually run flawlessly, like a native application.

Installing Wine on Linux

Installing Wine on Linux is easy. All you have to do is follow the steps to install Wine on any Ubuntu system, as given below.

Step 1: Open the terminal *Ctrl - Alt - T* and run the following command, which will install the *ppa*. You will be asked for your root password also.

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:Ubuntu-wine/ppa
```

Step 2: Now install Wine by typing the following command. You will notice the screens shown in Figures 1 and 2 during the installation.

```
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get install wine1.7
```

Step 3: To configure Wine, use the following command:

```
winecfg
```